Lena Varga-Holm

Senior Data Engineer | Data Platform

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with experience owning ingestion and orchestration for a production data platform spanning Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka. Delivered high-volume streaming, CDC and warehouse modernisation, including a 30-million-events-per-day pipeline and measurable improvements in latency, reliability, build time and cloud costs. Hands-on experience with Python, SQL and AWS data services; AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate.

CORE SKILLS

Data Engineering: Python, SQL, PySpark, batch and streaming data pipelines, change data capture (CDC)
Data Platform: Airflow, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Snowflake, dbt
Cloud and Warehousing: AWS MSK, AWS EMR, Amazon S3, Glue Data Catalog, Redshift
Quality, CI/CD and Infrastructure: Great Expectations, pytest, GitHub Actions, Terraform, data tests and documentation
Data Modelling: dbt models, incremental models, Redshift warehouse design

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. | 2022–Present

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform using Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka.
- Designed and built a shipment-event streaming pipeline using partner webhooks, Kafka and Kafka Connect to Snowflake via Snowpipe Streaming; processes around 30 million events per day with end-to-end latency under 2 minutes at p95.
- Added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling so failed events can be re-processed without data loss.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into dbt models with tests and documentation; introduced incremental models and slim CI with state:modified in GitHub Actions.
- Reduced the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes and made data lineage visible to analysts.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Reduced the Snowflake bill from approximately 38,000 to 24,000 per month in 2024 through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.
- Participate in the data platform on-call rotation, one week in six; mentor two mid-level engineers and run data platform office hours.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay | 2019–2022

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to match bank settlement files against internal ledgers.
- Reduced the finance team's manual reconciliation work from approximately 3 days to 4 hours per month-end.
- Worked on Redshift warehouse design and data quality using Great Expectations.

OPEN-SOURCE AND COMMUNITY

- Fixed a pagination bug and added tests in a community Airflow provider for a SaaS CRM API; two pull requests were merged in 2023.

- Teach SQL for beginners at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.
- Gave the talk “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup in 2024.

EDUCATION

MSc in Computer Science | Northgate Technical University
Thesis: Incremental materialized views

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | May 2024